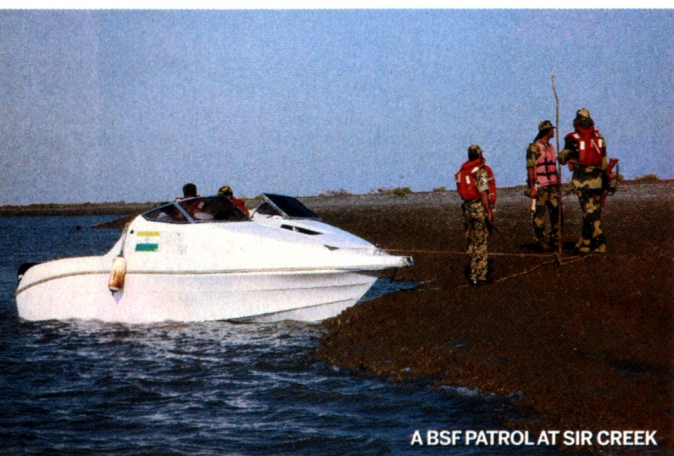


DELHI | The Baiting Game



A BSF PATROL AT SIR CREEK

After the 26/11 seaborne attacks, Indian security agencies are taking no chances even if the encounters that follow the heightened border watch risk becoming international incidents. In October, Indian UAVs detected intruders at a place called 'Harami Naala' in the disputed Sir Creek in Kutch, Gujarat.

Border Security Force (BSF) personnel flew an armed helicopter over the spot, firing on the intruders and killing at least six Pakistani fishermen. BSF officers say they have no way of telling whether it is a poaching attempt or insertion of terrorists. "It's no more business as usual," says one official. After their firing, the BSF received intelligence inputs that the Pakistani Rangers had mounted medium machine guns on fishing boats to lure and shoot down the helicopter. A solitary Pakistani fighter began patrolling the area as part of that hunt. The IAF then quickly dispatched MiGs from the Bhuj airbase, which flew over the helicopter and were able to foil the Pakistani plans.

by Sandeep Unnithan

Bride Right

With many Indian women getting trapped after marrying Gulf nationals, Indian missions in the UAE, Bahrain and Oman want the Indian Government to formulate new matrimony rules that will ensure equal inheritance rights for Indian wives.

DEHRADUN | Ban Aid For the Ganga

The receding Gangotri glacier has sent alarm bells ringing. Uttarakhand Chief Minister Ramesh Pokhriyal Nishank has decided to issue a complete ban on the unrestricted movement of people and pilgrims around Gaumukh, the snout of the glacier from where the Ganga originates. Nishank has declared that only 150 people will now be allowed to visit the glacier each month, down from the hundreds thronging the sacred spot. Geological experts have repeatedly warned the state Government that the glacier has retreated at an alarming rate and if it is not saved, the Ganga will eventually dry up, with catastrophic effects over northern India. Nishank is



THE GANGA AT GAUMUKH

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also worried about the garbage pilgrims leave behind. "The Ganga is our lifeline without which India will starve. There can be no compromise on such an important environmental issue," says the chief minister.

by Subhash Mishra

DELHI | CAT Scan

Authorities remain clueless about the glitch in the online Common Admission Test (CAT). The computer crash prevented about 2,000 students from taking the test meant for admissions to the country's leading management institutions. Twenty-four of the 104 CAT centres had reported systems failure.

HINDUSTAN TIMES



STUDENTS AT A CAT CENTRE

IIM-Ahmedabad has been quick to pass the buck to Prometric, the company in charge of the tests. "IIMs were only responsible for generating questions for the tests. The contracts for delivery of computerised CAT was awarded to Prometric." Prometric then passed the buck on two viruses, namely Conflicter and W32 Nimda, saying they were unable to detect the "malicious software". The HRD Ministry has now asked the convener of CAT to file a report on what caused the disruption.

by Mihir Srivastava